

Rating Area 9: Capital Region

Hub: Harrisburg | Counties: Cumberland, Dauphin, Franklin, Fulton, Juniata, Lebanon, Perry

21.5% PID-approved avg. individual rate hike	102% avg. net premium increase, 2026	443,024 PA enrollees as of June 1, 2026	160,000+ cumulative PA terminations
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THE STATEWIDE PICTURE

The federal enhanced premium tax credits expired December 31, 2025, and Congress has not restored them; combined with the Pennsylvania Insurance Department's (PID) approved 21.5% average individual-market rate increase, Pennie reports the average net premium for the affected population rose 102% for 2026 (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; Pennie, 2026a). Statewide, 85,000 people dropped Pennie coverage during Open Enrollment; as of June 1, 2026, cumulative cancellations exceed 160,000 and total enrollment stands at 443,024 (Pennie, 2026a, 2026b). Pennsylvania's own relief program, the Act 54 state subsidy, remains unfunded as the state budget missed its June 30, 2026 deadline for the fifth year running (Spotlight PA, 2026).

CARRIERS & RATES IN THIS AREA

Home to Capital Advantage Assurance Company (Capital Blue Cross), approved for a 24.6% individual-market increase for 2026, and to the state capital itself (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; WITF, 2025). Fulton and Juniata Counties, in this same rating area, are among the state's most rural and carrier-thin markets.

THE UNRESOLVED FIX IS BEING DECIDED TWO MILES FROM HERE

The Act 54 State Health Insurance Exchange Affordability Program — which would fund state-level premium assistance for households between 151%–300% of the federal poverty line, and which Pennie says is technically ready to deploy the moment it's funded — sits inside the General Assembly's still-unresolved FY2026–27 budget, being negotiated in this rating area's own backyard (Spotlight PA, 2026; Pennie, 2026b). Its outcome will affect eligible households statewide, not just here.

YOUR CONSUMER PROTECTIONS

If a directory error sends you out-of-network: 28 Pa. Code § 9.725 caps your liability at in-network cost-sharing, and Act 252 of 2023 presumes an undisclosed out-of-network balance bill illegal. The federal IDR process (45 C.F.R. § 149.510) is a *provider-vs-plan* tool only — you cannot file one yourself; use the protections above instead.

Enroll / compare plans: pennie.com or 1-844-844-8040
Free legal help: phlp.org or 1-800-274-3258

File a complaint: pa.gov/consumer or 1-866-722-6675
Medicare counseling: PA MEDI 1-800-783-7067

SOURCES (APA)

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